

Call framework + referral close script

FREE TEMPLATE

Open warm, listen 80%, close without asking for a referral, thank them within 2 hours.

The call, minute by minute (20 minutes)

STAGE	TIME	WHAT HAPPENS
Open	0-3 min	Ask "Anything exciting going on lately?" Then answer it yourself when they ask back: long and casual. You're setting the tone: this is a conversation, not an interview.
Your intro	3-5 min	Your 60-second intro, loosened up. Where you're from, what pulled you in, what you've done, why them.
Their story	5-15 min	How they got here, what they actually do day to day, what they'd do differently. 80% listening, 20% talking.
Questions that prove you listened	15-18 min	Follow-ups on what they just said beat anything you prepared. "You mentioned X. What did that look like?"
The close	18-20 min	"Is there anyone on the team you'd be comfortable introducing me to?" or "Is there another perspective you think would be good for me to hear?" Then thank them and end on time.

The close (never ask for a referral directly)

- ☐ "Is there anyone on the team you'd be comfortable introducing me to?"
- ☐ "Is there another perspective you think would be good for me to hear?"
- ☐ If no: "Totally understand, thank you for the time today." Then send the thank-you anyway. A "no" today is usually about timing, not about you.

Thank-you email (send 1-2 hours after the call)

Subject: Thank you, [First name]

Hi [First name],

Thank you for the call today. [Specific thing they said] really stuck with me, and I'm going to [specific action you'll take because of it].

I'll [next step you promised, e.g. "reach out to Sam as you suggested"] and let you know how it goes.

Thanks again,
[Your name]

Staying warm

WHEN	WHAT
Within 2 hours	Thank-you email with one specific detail.
When you act on their advice	A short update: "You suggested X; I did it and here's what happened."
Every 6-8 weeks	A one-line check-in with something real (a result, an article relevant to their work, a question).
Holidays	A personal note, not a template. One sentence about something they told you.
When recruiting opens	Tell them you're applying and ask one specific question about the process.